ALEX WADE

Staff Frontend Engineer

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Staff-level software engineer with 11 years of experience building and improving large-scale web applications across e-commerce and ed-tech environments. Front-end focused, passionate about software reliability, maintainability, and performance. Architects and ships end-to-end: design systems, micro-frontends, real-time interfaces, REST & GraphQL APIs, migration jobs, and developer tooling, with fluent AI-assisted workflows. Hands-on at every level of scope, from org-wide services to greenfield products.

SKILLS AND PROFICIENCIES

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Go, HTML, CSS/Sass, SQL, Bash, Ruby, (prior) PHP
Frontend & **Tooling:** React, Redux, Next.js, Vite, Vitest, Jest, React Testing Library, Webpack (SWC/esbuild/Rollup), SSR, micro-frontends, design systems
Backend & **Infra:** Node.js, Go REST APIs, GraphQL, WebSocket (native, Ably), WebRTC (Ably), AWS (Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, S3, EC2, CloudWatch, Athena), MySQL, Docker
Practice: AI-assisted development (Claude Code), technical design documents, test strategy, CI/CD (GH Actions, Jenkins), strict ESLint/Prettier toolchains

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lightspeed Systems – Remote (Austin, TX)
Staff Frontend Engineer Aug 2023 – *present*
Senior Software Engineer Apr 2022 – Aug 2023

Frontend architect on a K-12 safety and classroom platform serving 12M+ devices and hundreds of billions of daily requests. Sole maintainer of the company design system across 16+ applications and ~57 engineers; primary builder on 4 novel product apps handed off to their owning teams and 4 global services.

- **Architected and developed a flagship product overhaul**, "Filter Policies 2.0" – writing roughly ~95% of the implementation. Designed a nested policy tree with efficient resolution in both the UI and Go resolver API, balancing UX requirements against performance at scale. Built a customizable "Table" component, a recursive "Nested List" component, and a composite "Filters Bar", all used subsequently by other teams.
- **Rewrote a business-critical service running on millions of student devices**, first taking it from 0 to 91% unit and integration test coverage for safe transition; this coverage exposed a significant number of defects explaining chronic deploy incidents and on-call escalations that were then decisively resolved.
- **Sole owner/maintainer and primary contributor to the company design system** for 4 years – 129 components consumed by 16+ applications org-wide. Designed and built ~30 second-generation components.
- **Built first integrations with Platform team's global auth service**, for both the legacy Rails monoliths and JS/TS SPAs – patterns which were then adopted by Platform, Alert, Classroom, Signal, and MDM teams.
- **Architected and built a global app shell microfrontend**, demonstrated in Staging across 4 applications with 3 stacks (Rails MPA, React SPA, Go-templated MPA); designed for AI-assisted development with context docs, hotspot directory for high-churn files, strict deterministic gates enforced in CI (linting, formatting, testing), with 100% coverage on critical paths. Previously **designed and deployed a global navigation quasi-microfrontend** (API + library component) across 6 applications – the predecessor to the newer app shell awaiting prod.
- **Architected a real-time WebSocket streaming service**, "Live Web Activity", showing student device activity to school administrators – the first of its kind among cloud ed-tech competitors per internal analysis; also contributed to multi-device support and two-way chat on Ably-based WebSocket/WebRTC class sessions

- **Bootstrapped and handed off new product SPAs**: Filter policies, Signal core, Certificate Manager, Classroom admin – all complete with scaffolding, CI/CD, auth integration, and design system wiring.
- **Built the company's first global AI assistant frontend** – wrapping an n8n-based widget hooked into our MCPs with company design system and functionality into an independent deployable.
- **Set multiple engineering standards by proving their efficacy**: TypeScript adoption across design system and frontend apps, Vite migrations from CRA, technical design and whiteboarding documents, strict ESLint/Prettier configs, React SSR, and "RCS" (route-controller-service) pattern used across several Go APIs.
- **Performed expand-contract migration** on Classroom's scheduling data with seamless cutover

React · TypeScript · Go · Node.js · Rails · Vite · Vitest/Jest · GraphQL · AWS Lambda, Dynamo, S3

Scribd – Remote (San Francisco, CA)
Senior Software Engineer Mar 2021 – Apr 2022

Technical lead for the Subscriber UX and Design System teams on scribd.com and senior contributor on SlideShare, each serving 100M+ users. Owned architecture, technical documentation, and delivery across multiple frontend initiatives; sized and scoped work w/ Design and Product.

- Led **Content Quickview**, an A/B tested feature that increased click rate by 11.8% per Product analysis.
- Directed **Content Preview design system re-skin** and managed **cross-functional removal of legacy navigation bar**, lowering future design and development costs.
- Led technical discovery and implementation of a cross-functional DX initiative for Web team's development CLI, which included a complete re-write from Bash scripts to Node.js.
- Improved **Core Web Vitals** on SlideShare's highest-traffic page.

React/Redux · JavaScript · Jest/RTL · Webpack · Ruby on Rails

Nike – Beaverton, OR *(remote after Apr 2020)*
Senior Software Engineer (employed by **Kforce**, Inc) Mar 2020 – Mar 2021

Supported Nike Digital and Technology teams (Web Flex, Partners, Gameday) on nike.com e-commerce site and various nike.net wholesale and internal apps.

- Co-authored **Partner Hub** (partners.nike.com), Nike's first API portal for external developers
- Built **automated localization tool** for Gameday wholesale e-commerce app – the first use of Nike Digital's globalization platforms within Nike Technology org.
- Designed and built the **product catalog administration** UI for Gameday, and roughly halved login and application initialization time.
- Mentored junior developers on best practices, code quality, and unit testing.

React/Redux · JavaScript · Node.js · Next.js · Jest/Enzyme · Postgres · Jenkins · AWS

Fitera / **Vestright** – Happy Valley, OR
Senior Web Developer (promoted Jan 2018) Sept 2015 – Mar 2020

Led development of web applications and internal tools, including a React/CakePHP social platform on AWS. Owned infrastructure, code quality, and contractor and junior developer onboarding.

- Built a **sales call booking SPA** with a Node/MongoDB backend, analytics and authentication
- Modernized the primary company site and ran conversion optimization campaigns across sales pages, materially increasing mobile traffic and digital product sales; introduced Git version control, CI/CD, staging environment, and build tools across 5 codebases

JavaScript · React · CakePHP/PHP · MySQL · Node/Express · Redis · MongoDB · Webpack